Obinna Chukwuemeka

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PROFILE

Product Manager with 5+ years of experience building and scaling payment infrastructure products across fintech and digital financial services. Experienced in both offline and online acquiring, payment routing, EFT processing, collections, cross-border payments solutions, web3 onchain marketplace, and merchant payment solutions across multiple African markets. Proven track record of leading end-to-end product delivery, optimizing payment performance, coordinating cross-functional teams, and launching scalable payment solutions that improve transaction reliability and customer experience

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Core Competencies**: Technical Product R&D, Team Leadership, Product Lifecycle Management,Test-Driven Development, Go-to-Market Launch Plans, Troubleshooting & Debugging, QA Testing, B2B & C2B Solutions,Requirements Gathering & Analysis, Market & Competitor Research, Payment Processing Workflows, Technical Onboarding, Analytical Skills, Operational Efficiency
- **Tools**: Postman, Jira, Excel, Google Sheets, Confluence, Notion, Databases (MySQL), Figma, Slack, Microsoft Teams, ChatGPT/Claude, Microsoft Office Suite,

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

PalmPay Limited

Product Manager - Payment Product ***Lagos, Nigeria*** **April 2023 - Present**

- Implemented dynamic payment routing strategies, resulting in a 35% improvement in POS channel stability and enhanced success rate.
- Owned the end-to-end product roadmap for POS acquiring and payment processing platforms, managing payment flows and aligning cross-functional teams on a shared vision for payment processing workflows.
- Strengthened C2B and EFT payment flows, optimizing digital collections and improving success rates for businesses and end-users.
- Built and scaled lending products (B2C) across Nigeria and Tanzania, enabling seamless Flexi Loan disbursement and repayment through direct debit integrations, improving repayment efficiency.
- Expanded product portfolio to include bill payments, telco services, and value-added offerings, driving user stickiness and higher transaction volumes.
- Launched and localized digital payment solutions across 5 markets (Nigeria, Kenya, Tanzania, Ghana, ,Uganda)
- Maintained strategic relationships with vendors, banks, and fintech partners, translating business objectives into actionable product initiatives.
- Streamlined dispute resolution and settlement processes to achieve an improved reduction in resolution times.
- Provided technical product leadership, offering solution design inputs and guiding engineering teams to deliver scalable and user-centric platforms.
- Coordinated technical onboarding and integration initiatives with multiple banking partners, payment gateways, and fintech providers, ensuring solutions addressed user pain points.
- Managed the lifecycle of agents' business application products from ideation to launch, ensuring seamless user experience and measurable business value delivery.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with engineering, business teams, and external partners to achieve revenue targets and remove blockers across product initiatives.

Product operation specialist -(POS and Card Payment) ***Lagos, Nigeria*** **Sep 2022 - Mar 2023**

- Ensured the availability, stability, and reliability of POS and card payment systems across banks, switching partners, and payment processors.
- Monitored and supported live production environments, achieving 99.2% uptime across payment channels through proactive system monitoring and incident management.
- Investigated and resolved transaction failures, authorization issues, and system downtimes by analyzing application logs and transaction data.
- Collaborated with switching partners and service providers to promptly resolve escalations, settlement discrepancies, and channel disruptions.
- Proactively tracked transaction flows and system performance to identify anomalies, prevent service outages, and improve overall payment success rates.
- Partnered with Product and Engineering teams to recommend operational and system improvements that enhanced customer experience and reduced recurring payment issues.

UBA PLC

POS Support specialist ***Lagos, Nigeria*** **Jul 2021 - Aug 2022**

- Oversaw registration, onboarding of merchants at a high level, and profilling of merchants to accepts international card acceptance for POS merchants with Nigeria Central Switch, card scheme processors, and PTSPS
- Provided second-level technical support for subsidiaries across Anglophone and Francophone countries, resolving POS-related issues
- Managed onboarding processes for new PTSP partners, ensuring compliance with SLAs and agreement
- Collaborated with FEP switch, PTSPs, and processors to optimize network uptime and transaction efficiency
- Effective management of bank records for merchants, terminal inventory

EDUCATION

Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria, Kaduna **Mar 2026 - Present**
Masters in Information Management (in view)

Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria, Kaduna **Feb 2022 - Aug 2025**
Bachelor, Computer Science

Maritime Academy of Nigeria, Oron, Akwa Ibom **Oct 2014 - Oct 2018**
National Diploma, Marine Engineering

COURSES & CERTIFICATIONS

- Product Analytics Certification: Pendo.io (Feb 2026)
- Enhancing Financial Inclusion With A Risk-Based Approach: ACAMS (Sep 2025)
- Product Strategy Certification: Product School (Feb 2025)
- Product Discovery Micro-Certification: Product School (Nov 2024)
- API Product Manager Certification: API Academy (July 2024)
- Agile Explorer Certification: IBM (June 2024)

Some Key Achievements

- Led the launch of a device financing product across multiple African markets, enabling customers to acquire devices through embedded lending and structured repayments.
- Supported PalmPay migration from NIBSS Instant pay and integration of the NIBSS NPS platform in line with ISO 20022 standards, improving interoperability and transaction processing.
- Led the implementation and rollout of NIBSS geo-tagging solution for POS terminals, improving visibility, location tracking, and field support efficiency.
- Drove the implementation of dual PTSA connectivity implementation with engineering and switching partners, improving terminal reliability and transaction routing.
- Optimized payment channels and integrations (Paystack, Flutterwave, MTN Interswitch etc) improving payment channel stability and issue resolution across flows.
- Led mobile money disbursement and collection rollout across multiple markets, integrating Airtel Money, Tigo Pesa, and M-Pesa and other mobile money operator across Ghana, Tanzania, Uganda, and Kenya.
- Delivered end-to-end implementation of international card acceptance across multiple schemes, enabling seamless cross-border transactions.
- Improved POS payment routing strategies, resulting in a 35% increase in transaction success and stability.
- Coordinated payment integrations and onboarding with banks, fintechs, and processors across multiple African markets.